

Coral Reef Drawing

Easy start · Indoors · Kid can lead · Ages 5–10 · 30 min

Brought to you by Kiyah — “Look closer. Then draw what you saw.”

Draw a reef packed so full of hiding places that every fish you add has somewhere to go.

WHAT YOU NEED

- A large sheet of paper
- Markers, crayons, or colored pencils
- Optional: blue paint or a blue wash for the water

BEFORE YOU START

Cover the table if you are using anything wet.

How to make it

- 1 Color or wash the whole page blue first, and let it dry. Reefs live underwater, so the water goes down before anything else.
- 2 Draw the reef floor as a bumpy line across the bottom third of the page.
- 3 Build the reef upward with three shapes: branches, domes, and fans. Overlap them so gaps appear between them.
- 4 Fill in color, but leave the gaps dark. Those gaps are the important part.
- 5 Now add sea creatures. Every creature has to be near a gap it could hide in.
- 6 Add one creature that is very hard to find, and challenge someone to find it.

TALK ABOUT IT

What would happen to the creatures in your drawing if the reef disappeared?

TRY THIS TOO

Draw the same reef at night. Which creatures come out and which ones tuck away?

DID YOU KNOW? · NATURE & ANIMALS

Coral reefs give sea animals food and shelter. A reef is built by tiny living animals called coral polyps. All those branches and gaps make hiding places and feeding grounds, which is why a small patch of reef can hold more kinds of creature than the open water around it.